

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 859

By Massey

A RESOLUTION to commend Ocean Edwards for exemplary service as a legislative intern.

WHEREAS, each legislative session, this General Assembly is pleased to recognize certain persons who have committed themselves, through their adroit service, to the betterment of the legislative process; and

WHEREAS, Ocean Edwards is one such individual, who has distinguished himself in his role as a legislative intern for Senator Becky Massey; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Edwards's work, his exceptionally personable demeanor, and his professionalism have resulted in innumerable benefits for the legislators he assisted, the constituents of Senate District 6, and the General Assembly as a whole; and

WHEREAS, Ocean Edwards brought leadership, campaign management, event coordination, and community outreach skills to his time with the legislature, mailing more than 500 copies of the *Tennessee Blue Book* and participating in Tennessee State Trivia, hosted by librarian Eddie Weeks for legislative interns, as a member of the winning team; and

WHEREAS, a student at the University of Tennessee, Knoxville (UTK), where he is highly regarded by his peers, Mr. Edwards has achieved academic success while pursuing a Bachelor of Science degree in Political Science with a minor in History; and

WHEREAS, Ocean Edwards is a compassionate volunteer with a background in church community service. In 2024, he taught Bible classes with Christ Fellowship Knoxville, and from 2022 to 2025, he served Shoreline Youth in several capacities; from 2024 to 2025, Mr. Edwards was a volunteer for Thrive Lonsdale, a Christian after-school program that seeks to meet the physical and spiritual needs of underprivileged children; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Edwards has served the Phi Slam Ministry as campus director since August 2024, spreading the gospel on the campus of UTK and connecting young men to fellowship, discipleship, and the church; and

WHEREAS, a leader in his community and beyond, Ocean Edwards served on Senator Becky Massey's reelection campaigns in 2021 and 2024 and as a Senate Page in 2020 and 2022; he was also a youth representative for the Town of Farragut Education Relations Committee and a volunteer at the Second Harvest Food Bank of East Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, additionally, he has devoted his time and talents as a campaign manager for Senator Richard Briggs since September 2025, in which role he has collaborated with the media, volunteer, and logistics teams to ensure campaign alignment and execution; organized events to increase publicity; and participated in the recruiting and hiring process; and

WHEREAS, in his leisure time, Mr. Edwards enjoys hiking, backpacking, camping, running, pickleball, and history; and

WHEREAS, eager to familiarize himself with the characteristics and complexities of Tennessee State government and to further his studies, Ocean Edwards brought his many abilities and singular expertise to Capitol Hill for the 2026 session of the One Hundred Fourteenth General Assembly; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Edwards has performed his many duties with extraordinary insight and rare decorum; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we hereby commend Ocean Edwards for outstanding service as a legislative intern for Senator Becky Massey and extend to him our best wishes for every future success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.